browser.

Actions
: Actions declare that you are interested in having Stimulus do something in response to an event on the page.

Targets
: Targets are DOM elements that are of interest to a controller, typically because the controller is using the element to determine the state of the page or because the controller is using the state of the page to change the element.

Data maps and values
: Data maps and values are state that is stored in the DOM that is of interest to a controller. Stimulus allows you to declare the types of these values in your controller, though, as you'll see, doing so conflicts a little bit with TypeScript.

Classes
: A common use of data maps and values is to represent CSS classes. Stimulus provides a special mechanism for managing and updating CSS classes on DOM elements.

Stimulus and React represent two different sides of a long-standing debate over how to structure a web application. (We'll take a look at React in Chapter 4, *React*.) Stimulus is of the opinion that a web application primarily is based on the server, and the role of the client is to provide some interactivity but on top of the markup that is rendered on the server. Stimulus makes extensive use of HTML markup to specify the interaction between HTML and JavaScript. This is unlike React, which uses its own JSX markup, and also unlike jQuery, which tries to keep JavaScript logic outside the HTML markup.